A BRIEF HISTORY OF JAVASCRIPT

1995

- Brendan Eich creates the **very first version of JavaScript in just 10 days**. It was called Mocha, but already had many fundamental features of modern JavaScript!

1996

- Mocha changes to LiveScript and then to JavaScript, in order to attract Java developers. However, **JavaScript has almost nothing to do with Java** ☝️
- Microsoft launches IE, **copying JavaScript from Netscape** and calling it JScript;

1997

- With a need to standardize the language, ECMA releases ECMAScript 1 (ES1), the first **official standard for JavaScript** (ECMAScript is the standard, JavaScript the language in practice);

2009

- ES5 (ECMAScript 5) is released with lots of great new features;

2015

- ES6/ES2015 (ECMAScript 2015) was released: **the biggest update to the language ever!**
- ECMAScript changes to an **annual release cycle** in order to ship less features per update 🙏

2016 – ∞

- Release of ES2016 / ES2017 / ES2018 / ES2019 / ES2020 / ES2021 / ... / ES2089 😅

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BACKWARDS COMPATIBILITY: DON'T BREAK THE WEB!

```
// ES1 Code
function add(n) {
  var x = 5 + add.arguments[0];
  return x;
}
```

1997

BACKWARDS COMPATIBLE

Modern JavaScript Engine

2020

DON'T BREAK THE WEB!

- Old features are **never** removed;
- Not really new versions, just **incremental updates** (releases)
- Websites keep working **forever**!

Modern JavaScript Engine

2020

NOT FORWARDS COMPATIBLE

```
// ES2089 Code 😂
c int add n <=> int 5 + n
```

2089

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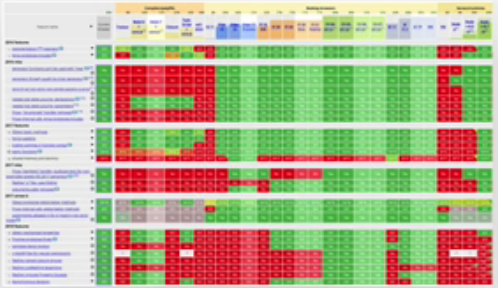
HOW TO USE MODERN JAVASCRIPT TODAY

🕵️ **During development:** Simply use the latest Google Chrome!

🚀 **During production:** Use Babel to transpile and polyfill your code (converting back to ES5 to ensure browser compatibility for all users).



http://kangax.github.io/compat-table

ES5

- 👉 Fully supported in all browsers (down to IE 9 from 2011);
- 👉 Ready to be used today 👍

BABEL

ES6/ES2015 ↓ ES2020

- 👉 **ES6+**: Well supported in all **modern** browsers;
- 👉 No support in **older** browsers;
- 👉 Can use **most** features in production with transpiling and polyfilling 😃

ES2021 – ∞

- 👉 **ESNext**: Future versions of the language (new feature proposals that reach Stage 4);
- 👉 Can already use **some** features in production with transpiling and polyfilling.

(As of 2020)

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MODERN JAVASCRIPT FROM THE BEGINNING

🔥 Learn **modern JavaScript from the beginning!**

☝️ But, also learn how some things used to be done **before** modern JavaScript (e.g. `const` & `let` vs `var` and function constructors vs ES6 `class`).

3 reasons why we should not forget the Good Ol' JavaScript:

- 👉 You will better understand how JavaScript actually works;
- 👉 Many tutorials and code you find online today are still in ES5;
- 👉 When working on old codebases, these will be written in ES5.

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